

TRUSTMRR MARKET SCAN

Where Capital Should — and Shouldn't — Go

Six data-backed findings from 1,000 TrustMRR listings, and what each one means for sourcing, screening, and pricing decisions.

AI absorbs the volume; five quieter signals absorb the returns

Across 1,000 listings, the clearest capital-allocation edge isn't in the category everyone is chasing — it's in where monetization, distribution, and pricing diverge from the hype.

FINDING	GOVERNING INSIGHT	EVIDENCE	ACTION
01	AI is crowded, not superior	55% of AI listings monetize — behind Sales, Education, Content Creation & Marketing	Screen AI deals harder than the category label suggests
02	B2B out-earns B2C 5.7×	Median MRR: B2B \$1,036 vs. B2C \$181, on fewer listings	Bias sourcing toward B2B even though B2C is louder
03	A buyable pool has traction, not revenue	29 listings carry real subscribers/followers with \$0 MRR	Build a monetize-and-flip sourcing list from this pool
04	A quarter of “for sale” listings are priced on story	64 of 262 ask real money for <\$50/mo MRR — up to \$1.5M	Underwrite every deal on MRR × multiple, not the ask
05	India is a volume trap	3rd-largest source of listings, but median MRR is \$6 vs. \$1,262 in the US	Verify pricing power before following listing volume
06	Tooling choice signals operator quality	Superwall users: \$5,465 median MRR vs. \$663 for plain Stripe	Add payment-stack sophistication to the scouting checklist

How we read the dataset

Scope

All 1,000 TrustMRR listings, frozen 30 Jul 2026. Core revenue fields (MRR, 12-mo revenue, subscriptions) are complete for 100% of rows.

Monetization threshold

A listing is “monetized” if its MRR is at or above the dataset median of \$282/month — the natural midpoint of a long-tail distribution.

Segmentation logic

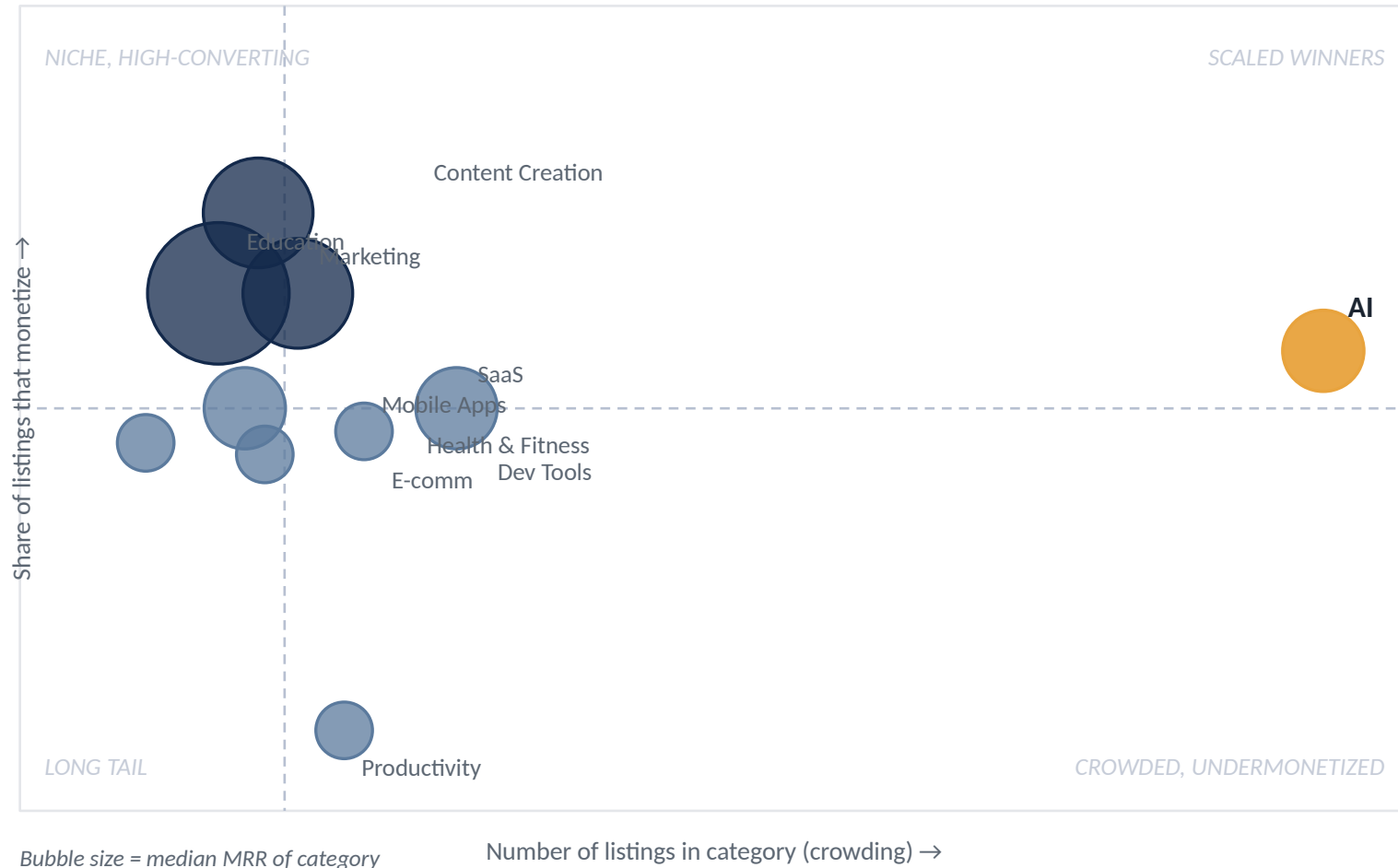
Listings are split into four monetization stages using MRR, active subscriptions, and X-follower counts as a distribution proxy.

Known gaps

Category, country, pricing model and audience type are self-reported and missing for 24–36% of rows — shares below are of the full 1,000, not of known-field subsets.

FINDING 1 OF 6

AI has 3× the listings of any other category — and only middling odds of paying off

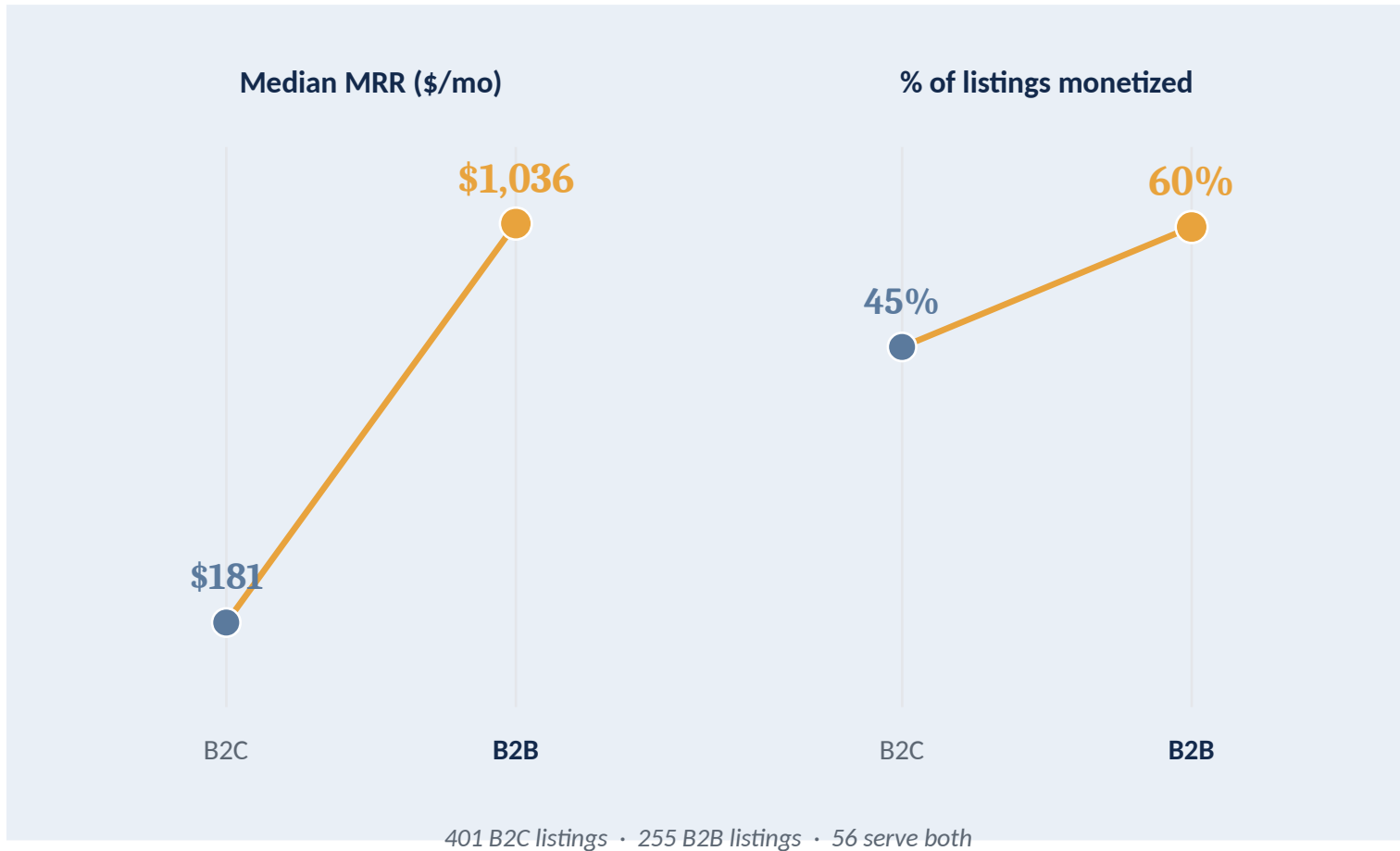


IMPLICATION FOR THE FIRM

AI is the biggest haystack, not the best odds. A random AI listing is less likely to be monetized than a random listing in Sales, Education, Content Creation, or Marketing.

Don't fund "AI" as a category thesis — raise the underwriting bar for AI deals specifically, and treat the category label as noise, not signal.

B2B businesses are outnumbered 1.6-to-1, yet earn 5.7× more per business

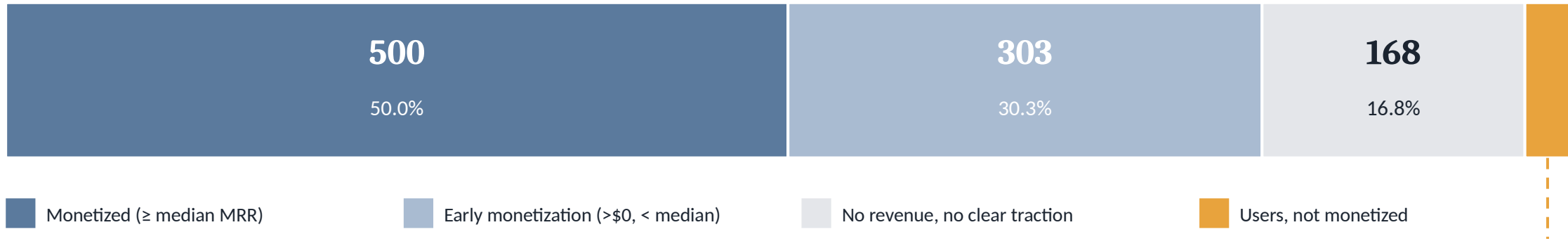


IMPLICATION FOR THE FIRM

B2C dominates the deal flow you'll see by volume — but B2B businesses convert visitors into payers more often, and charge more per customer once they do.

Weight sourcing and diligence time toward B2B, even when B2B deals are the minority in a given batch. A B2C listing needs a materially bigger user base to match a B2B listing's revenue.

Half the dataset monetizes. A 29-listing sliver has traction it hasn't cashed in yet



Who are the 29?

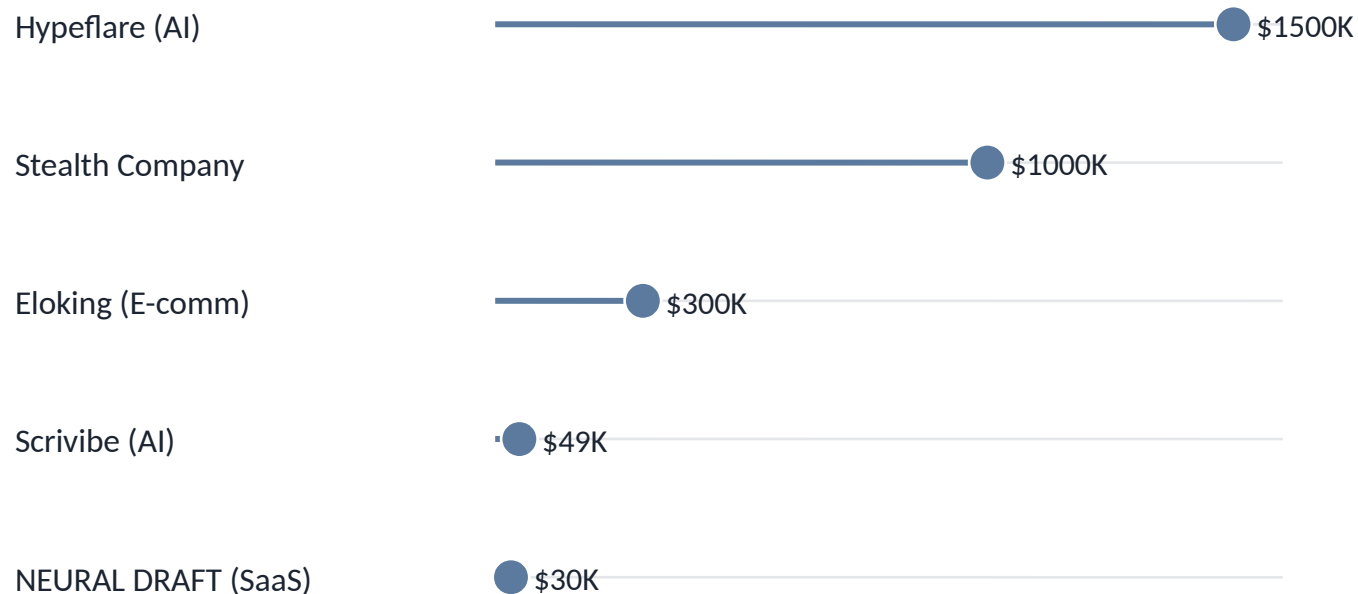
Listings with active subscribers or 500+ X followers but \$0 recorded MRR — they've already solved the hard part of a startup (getting an audience) and simply haven't built a paywall around it.

IMPLICATION

This is a ready-made, cheap acquisition thesis: buy the distribution, install monetization — don't pay a premium for revenue that already exists elsewhere.

A quarter of “for sale” listings ask a real price for a business earning almost nothing

Asking price for listings earning < \$50/month in MRR



Every listing above earns \$0–\$34/month — the asking price reflects brand, audience, or domain value, not cash flow.

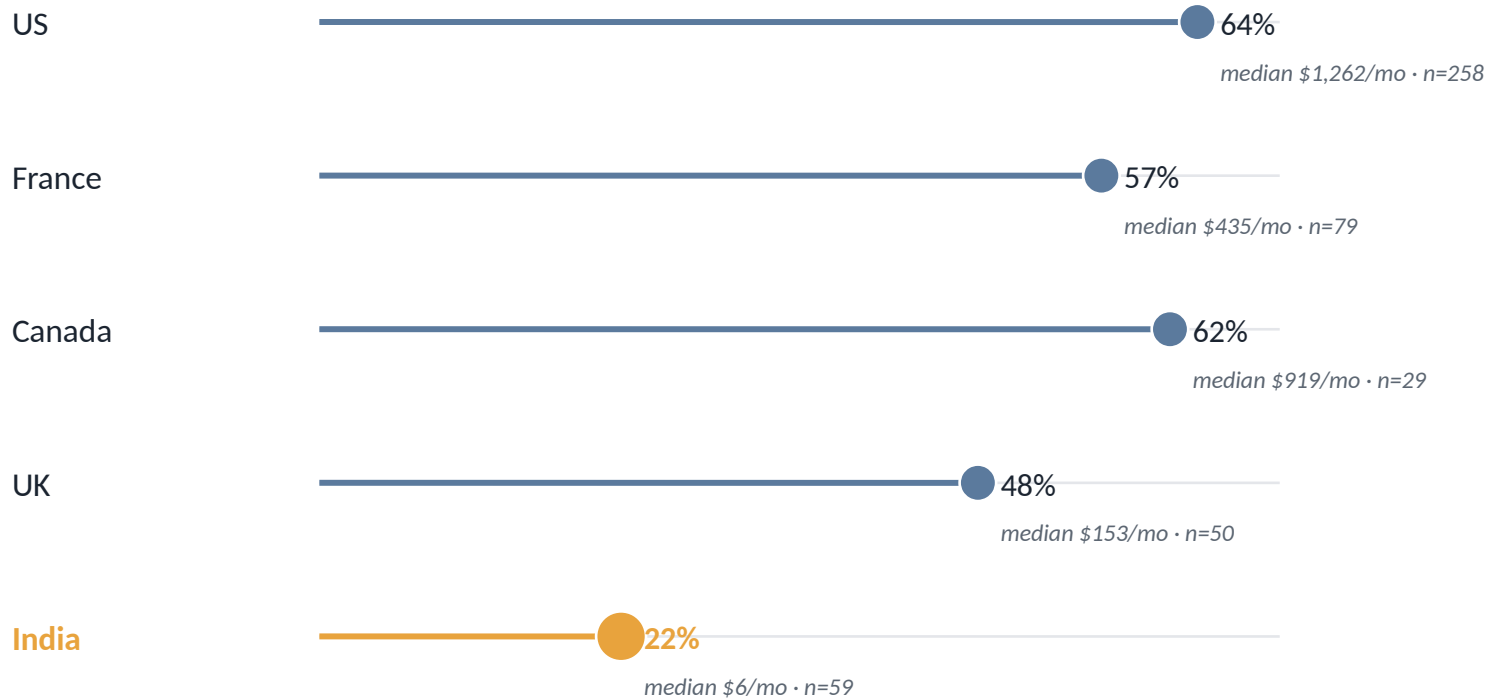
IMPLICATION FOR THE FIRM

64 of 262 for-sale listings price on a story instead of cash flow — revenue multiples across the pool run from 0.0x to 26x current MRR.

Make MRR-vs-asking-price the first underwriting check, not a footnote. Reject or heavily haircut any offer where the multiple can’t be explained by growth, IP, or audience value you can independently verify.

India supplies the 3rd-most listings — and by far the weakest monetization

% of listings monetized, by country (top 5 by listing count)



IMPLICATION FOR THE FIRM

India listings are as numerous as the UK's but monetize at a third of the rate, with a median MRR near zero.

That cuts two ways: it may be a market with weak willingness-to-pay (avoid), or an underpriced market nobody has monetized well yet (move early and cheap). Don't treat it as neutral — flag it for a targeted follow-up before sourcing there at volume.

Founders who invest in paywall tooling earn far more than those on default Stripe

Median MRR by payment / billing provider



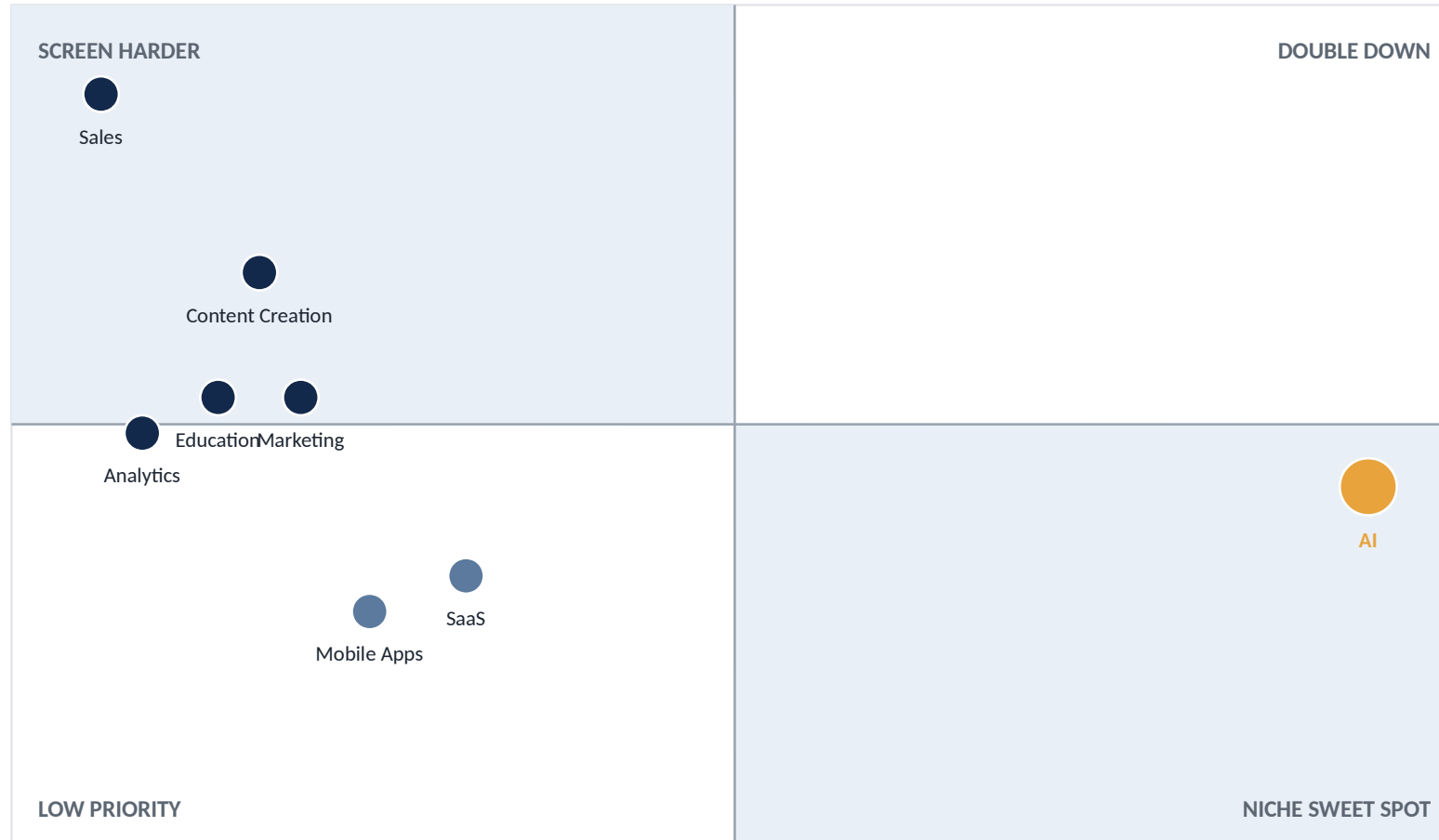
IMPLICATION FOR THE FIRM

Superwall (paywall A/B-testing tooling) users post 8× the median MRR of plain Stripe users. Sample sizes are small, but the pattern lines up with intuition: founders who invest in monetization tooling tend to be more revenue-serious operators.

Add payment-stack sophistication to the scouting checklist as a cheap, fast signal — not a standalone decision rule.

Where each category sits on volume vs. monetization — and what to do about it

↑ % monetized



Volume (# listings) →

READING THE MAP

AI sits alone in the upper-left — unmatched volume, mid-pack odds. The real “sweet spot” cluster (Sales, Content Creation, Education) is smaller but converts far better.

A sourcing strategy weighted only by deal volume over-indexes on the wrong quadrant.

Three moves, sequenced

NOW

Re-weight the screen

Rebuild the deal-scoring rubric so category volume no longer proxies for quality. Score Sales, Education, Content Creation, Marketing and Analytics deals on equal footing with AI, not below it by default.

NEXT

Build the two watchlists

Stand up a sourcing list of the 29 traction-not-monetized listings for an acquire-and-monetize play, and a red-flag list of for-sale listings priced above 10x MRR for extra diligence.

LATER

Test the India hypothesis

Commission a fast, targeted look at 5-10 India-based listings to determine whether the low monetization is a pricing-power problem or an inefficient, still-open market.

Read the findings with these limits in mind

Self-reported revenue

MRR and revenue figures come from founders' connected Stripe/RevenueCat accounts via TrustMRR and were not independently verified for this analysis.

Uneven field completeness

Category (73%), country (76%), pricing model (66%) and audience type are all partially missing. Category- and country-level shares are computed against the full 1,000-row base.

Small samples in some cuts

Superwall (n=17) and Whop (n=7) medians are directionally useful but not statistically robust — treat as a signal to investigate, not a standalone rule.

Snapshot, not a trend line

This is a single frozen snapshot (30 Jul 2026). It shows where listings stand today, not their trajectory — 30-day growth data is noisy and mostly flat at the median.

THE TAKEAWAY

Chase monetization, not category labels.

AI will keep generating the most listings. It won't keep generating the best odds — those sit in quieter categories, in the traction-not-cash pool, and in a disciplined read of asking price against MRR.

Thank you — questions welcome